system. Saturn is called as the **Ringed Planet**. It is because of large, beautiful and extensive ring systems that encircles the planet. These rings are mostly made from the chunks of ice and carbonaceous dust. **Saturn** is the only planet in our solar system whose average density is less than water.

The Saturn has 30 rings and 53confirmed natural satellites. The Saturn takes 10 hours 34 minutes to complete one rotation on its axis and it takes 29.4 years to complete one revolution around the sun.

The Uranus

Uranus is the seventh planet from the sun and it is not visible to the naked eye. Like Venus, Uranus also rotates on its axis from east to west. Uranus is inclined on its axis at an angle of 98 degrees. The planet is almost lying on its side as it goes around the sun. The sunlight, thus, is received mostly in the polar areas. Hydrogen, helium and methane are the major gases of its atmosphere. It is very cold due to its great distance from the sun. Uranus is named after the ancient Greek god of the sky. It has a dense atmosphere primarily consisting of methane, which lends it a bluish-green appearance. Uranus also has rings and twenty-seven satellites.

The Neptune

Neptune is the eighth planet from the sun. It takes 16 hours to complete one rotation on its own axis and it takes nearly 165 years to revolve around the sun. It has 13 natural satellites and 5 rings. It is the **coldest planet** in the Solar System because it is the farthest planet from the Sun. Neptune was the first planet located through mathematical calculations. Neptune is our solar system's windiest planet.

HOTS

Which planet may float on water and why?

2.8 Dwarf Planets

Dwarf planets are tiny planets in our solar system. Any celestial body orbiting around the sun, weighing for the self gravity and nearly be round in shape is called 'Dwarf Planet'. It should not be a satellite of any planet. They are five in number Ceres, Pluto, Heumea, Makemake and Eris. As Pluto has not cleared the neighbourhood around its orbit, it is officially demoted in 2006 from its ninth position as a planet.

2.9 Satellites

The word 'Satellite' means companion. The moon was the only known satellite in the Solar System until 1610. Today, there are 163 known satellites in the Solar System. The satellites move around a planet from West to East. They do not have own light, but reflect the light of the Sun. They have no atmosphere and water.

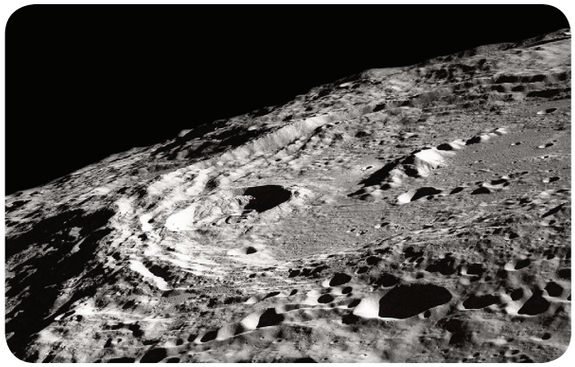


Figure 2.7 Surface of the Moon

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